RJMLAIRD.DEV

Brand Identity & Design System Specifications Guide

VERSION 1.0

1. BRAND OVERVIEW & POSITIONING

The **rjmlaird.co.uk** and **rjmlaird-dev** visual identity establishes an authoritative, high-performance dark-theme design system. Crafted for engineering leadership, open-source architecture, and technical journalism, it balances analytical precision with sleek modern restraint.

Core Positioning

High-density, accessible engineering hub tailored for technical leaders, collaborators, and enterprise clients.

Brand Personality

Analytical, direct, transparent, and polished. Avoids marketing fluff in favor of code, metrics, and structural clarity.

2. LOGO & IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

Primary Wordmark Standard: Rendered in `Space Grotesk (700 weight)`, size `0.95rem`, letter-spacing `0.04em`. High-contrast foreground text `--w (#EDEAE3)` paired with single-token teal accent `--teal (#00C2A8)`.



3. COLOR PALETTE & TOKEN ARCHITECTURE

Token Name	HEX Code	RGB Value	Semantic Role
`--ink`	#0B0F1A	11, 15, 26	Primary background surface
`--ink2`	#0F1520	15, 21, 32	Secondary container background
`--card`	#141B29	20, 27, 41	Elevated module / card surface
`--lift`	#1A2236	26, 34, 54	Hover / active interactive state
`--teal`	#00C2A8	0, 194, 168	Primary brand interactive accent
`--amber`	#F5A623	245, 166, 35	Warning / active status / highlights

4. TYPOGRAPHY & TYPE HIERARCHY

Display: Space Grotesk

Used for primary headlines, Section titles, and logo marks. Set with `text-wrap: balance`.

```
font-weight: 700; tracking: -.03em;
```

Body: Inter

Used for clean prose, lists, and general interface text. Configured with `text-wrap: pretty`.

```
line-height: 1.6; color: --mb;
```

5. LAYOUT PRINCIPLES & GEOMETRY

The design layout relies on structured geometry with strict component padding and responsiveness tokens derived directly from `global.css`:

Max Container Width: `1320px (--content-max)`

Border Radius: `6px (--radius)`

Section Padding: `clamp(3rem, 6vw, 5rem)`

6. IMAGERY, ICONOGRAPHY & STATUS SIGNALS

Media Containers

16:9 aspect ratio standard for project media. Images feature dark overlays with `border-radius: 1rem` and blurred attribution chips.

Status Dots & Badges

System status uses semantic color tokens: ● Active, ● Pending, ● Alert, and ● Security.

7. VOICE, TONE & PRACTICAL GUIDANCE

Preferred Voice Principles	Avoided Patterns
"Rigorous architecture built for performance and accessibility."	Vague corporate buzzwords and marketing hyperbole.
"Open-source contributions focused on developer experience."	Low-contrast text pairings violating WCAG standards.
"Direct technical documentation backed by measurable metrics."	Unformatted inline code blocks or mixed font families.

> **Accessibility & Compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA+):** All text/surface combinations meet or exceed 4.5:1 contrast ratios. Focus rings use `3px solid #7FE6D4` with 4px offsets.